GRANT GUIDELINES

High Country Rapid Response & Resilience Fund Guidelines

Rolling emergency grant · Open year-round

At a glance

Funding: Up to $10,000; most awards range from $2,500 to $7,500

Type of support: Emergency response or preparedness project support

Term: Funds must be spent within six months of award

Geographic eligibility: Organizations must be responding to emergencies affecting residents of Coconino, Yavapai, Navajo, or Apache counties, including tribal lands within those counties.

Program page: https://hufsa-stack.github.io/cinder-peaks-community-foundation/grants/rapid-response-resilience-fund/

About the program

The High Country Rapid Response & Resilience Fund was created after the 2010 Schultz Fire and post-fire flooding outside Flagstaff. It provides fast, flexible funding to organizations helping residents during and after emergencies, and supports preparedness projects between disasters.

Requests are reviewed on a rolling basis, and most decisions are made within ten business days. During a declared emergency the Foundation may open a dedicated response window with expedited review, announced on this page.

Focus and impact areas

Focus areas: Health & Human Services, Environment & Land Stewardship.

We welcome proposals that address one or more of the following impact areas:

- Emergency food, water, shelter, and supplies
- Recovery support for displaced households
- Post-fire flood mitigation and cleanup
- Community preparedness, evacuation planning, and resilience projects
- Mental health and wellness support after disasters

Populations served

- Households affected by wildfire, flooding, or severe weather
- Older adults and people with disabilities during emergencies
- Rural and tribal communities with limited emergency services

Eligibility

Geographic eligibility

Organizations must be responding to emergencies affecting residents of Coconino, Yavapai, Navajo, or Apache counties, including tribal lands within those counties.

Who may apply

- Tax-exempt under Section 501(c)(3), a public agency, a federally recognized tribe, tribal chapter, or tribal program, or a project with a qualified fiscal sponsor
- Responding to a specific emergency, or carrying out a preparedness project, in the four-county region
- Able to spend grant funds within six months of award

What we do not fund

- Direct payments to individuals (the Foundation funds organizations that assist individuals)
- Costs already covered by insurance or FEMA reimbursement
- Permanent rebuilding of structures

Funding

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Key dates

Milestone	Date
Application review	Requests are accepted year-round and reviewed on a rolling basis. Most decisions are made within ten business days.

How to apply

The rapid response request is a two-page form designed to be completed in under an hour.

1. **Call or email first.** Contact the Vice President of Grants & Community Impact to describe the need. Staff will confirm whether the request fits the fund.
2. **Complete the request form.** Download and complete the Rapid Response Request Form. A budget table is included in the form.
3. **Submit by email.** Email the completed form to grants@cinderpeakscf.org with the subject line "Rapid Response – [Organization Name]".
4. **Decision and payment.** Most decisions are made within ten business days. Approved grants are paid by direct deposit or check.

Review criteria

- Urgency and severity of the need
- The applicant's connection to the affected community
- Ability to deliver help quickly
- Coordination with emergency management, tribal, and relief agencies

Reporting requirements

Grantees submit a one-page Rapid Response Use of Funds Report within 60 days of spending the grant.

- How funds were used and how many people were helped
- Photos, if available, with permission noted
- Any remaining needs in the community

Due: Within 60 days after funds are spent.

Templates and supporting documents

- **Rapid Response Request Form:** https://hufsa-stack.github.io/cinder-peaks-community-foundation/documents/templates/cpcf-rapid-response-request-form.pdf
- **Rapid Response Use of Funds Report:** https://hufsa-stack.github.io/cinder-peaks-community-foundation/documents/reporting/cpcf-rapid-response-use-of-funds-report.pdf

Questions?

Marcus Tsosie, Vice President, Grants & Community Impact

Email: mtsosie@cinderpeakscf.org · Phone: (928) 555-0147 ext. 112

Cinder Peaks Community Foundation, 1120 N. Cinder Basin Road, Suite 200, Flagstaff, AZ 86001